

Gharial

Crocodiles have been on Earth for 80 million years, and are great survivors. Unlike other crocodiles the gharial (ga-ree-al) has no interest in catching birds or mammals. It only eats fish. Its long, thin jaws are lined with more than 100 sharp teeth. With a sudden snap, it grabs its slippery supper and gulps it down whole.

The gharial's tail has a row of huge plates along the top. A reptile cannot shiver or sweat, so these plates help the gharial warm up and cool down by absorbing heat from the Sun. Big male gharials also have a strange lump on the end of their nose. This helps them make loud buzzes and hisses to impress females.

Gharial, Southern Asia

